

ABEKA SCHOLAR ACADEMY

Elementary Reading Curriculum

Official Curriculum & Study Material

Chapter 1

Welcome to our advanced study module on Children's literature. We have a massive amount of material to cover. Let us begin. Children's literature or juvenile literature includes stories, books, magazines, and poems that are created for children. In addition to conventional literary genres, modern children's literature is classified by the intended age of the reader, ranging from picture books for the very young to young adult fiction for those nearing maturity. Children's literature can be traced to traditional stories like fairy tales, which have only been identified as children's literature since the seventeenth century, and songs, part of a wider oral tradition, which adults shared with children before publishing existed. The development of early children's literature, before printing was invented, is difficult to trace.

Even after printing became widespread, many classic "children's" tales were originally created for adults and later adapted for a younger audience. Since the fifteenth century much literature has been aimed specifically at children, often with a moral or religious message. Children's literature has been shaped by religious sources, like Puritan traditions, or by more philosophical and scientific standpoints with the influences of Charles Darwin and John Locke. The late nineteenth and early twentieth centuries are known as the "Golden Age of Children's Literature" because many classic children's books were published then. == Definition == There is no single, universally accepted definition of children's literature. It is broadly defined as the body of written works and accompanying illustrations produced in order to entertain or instruct young people.

This body of literature encompasses a wide range of works, including acknowledged classics of world literature, picture books and easy-to-read stories written exclusively for children, and fairy tales, lullabies, fables, folk songs, and other works that originate from oral traditions. It can be more specifically defined as fiction, non-fiction, poetry, or drama intended for and used by children and young people. One writer on children's literature defines it as "all books written for children, excluding works such as comic books, joke books, cartoon books, and non-fiction works that are not intended to be read from front to back, such as dictionaries, encyclopedias, and other reference materials".

However, others would argue that children's comics should also be included: "Children's Literature studies has traditionally treated comics fitfully and superficially despite the importance of comics as a

global phenomenon associated with children". The International Companion Encyclopedia of Children's Literature notes that "the boundaries of genre... are not fixed but blurred". Sometimes, no agreement can be reached about whether a given work is best categorized as literature for adults or children. Some works defy easy categorization. J. K. Rowling's Harry Potter series was written and marketed for children, but it is also popular among adults. The series' extreme popularity led The New York Times to create a separate bestseller list for children's books. Despite the widespread association of children's literature with picture books, spoken narratives existed before printing, and the root of many children's tales go back to ancient storytellers. Seth Lerer, in the opening of *Children's Literature: A Reader's History from Aesop to Harry Potter*, says, "This book presents a history of what children have heard and read....

The history I write of is a history of reception. " == History == Early children's literature consisted of spoken stories, songs, and poems, used to educate, instruct, and entertain children. It was only in the eighteenth century, with the development of the concept of childhood, that a separate genre of children's literature began to emerge, with its own divisions, expectations, and canon. The earliest of these books were educational books, books on conduct, and simple ABCs—often decorated with animals, plants, and anthropomorphic letters. In 1962, French historian Philippe Ariès argued in his book *Centuries of Childhood* that the modern concept of childhood only emerged in recent times. He explains that children were in the past not considered as fundamentally different from adults and were not given significantly different treatment.

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As evidence for this position, he notes that, apart from instructional and didactic texts for children written by clerics like the Venerable Bede and Ælfric of Eynsham, there was a lack of any genuine literature aimed specifically at children before the 18th century. Other scholars have qualified this viewpoint by noting that there was a literature designed to convey the values, attitudes, and information necessary for children within their cultures, such as the *Play of Daniel* from the twelfth century. Pre-modern children's literature, therefore, tended to be of a didactic and moralistic nature, with the purpose of conveying conduct-related, educational and religious lessons. === Early-modern Europe === During the seventeenth century, the concept of childhood began to emerge in Europe.

Adults saw children as separate beings, innocent and in need of protection and training by the adults around them. The English philosopher John Locke developed his theory of the *tabula rasa* in his 1690

An Essay Concerning Human Understanding. In Locke's philosophy, *tabula rasa* was the theory that the (human) mind is at birth a "blank slate" without rules for processing data, and that data is added and rules for processing are formed solely by one's sensory experiences. A corollary of this doctrine was that the mind of the child was born blank and that it was the duty of the parents to imbue the child with correct notions. Locke himself emphasized the importance of providing children with "easy pleasant books" to develop their minds rather than using force to compel them: "Children may be cozen'd into a knowledge of the letters; be taught to read, without perceiving it to be anything but a sport, and play themselves into that which others are whipp'd for.

" He also suggested that picture books be created for children. In the nineteenth century, a few children's titles became famous as classroom reading texts. Among these were the fables of Aesop and Jean de la Fontaine and Charles Perrault's 1697 *Tales of Mother Goose*. The popularity of these texts led to the creation of a number of nineteenth-century fantasy and fairy tales for children which featured magic objects and talking animals. Another influence on this shift in attitudes came from Puritanism, which stressed the importance of individual salvation. Puritans were concerned with the spiritual welfare of their children, and there was a large growth in the publication of "good godly books" aimed squarely at children. Some of the most popular works were by James Janeway, but the most enduring book from this movement, still read today, especially in modernised versions, is *The Pilgrim's Progress* (1678) by John Bunyan.

Chapbooks, pocket-sized pamphlets that were often folded instead of being stitched, were published in Britain; illustrated by woodblock printing, these inexpensive booklets reprinted popular ballads, historical re-tellings, and folk tales. Though not specifically published for children at this time, young people enjoyed the booklets as well. Johanna Bradley says, in *From Chapbooks to Plum Cake*, that chapbooks kept imaginative stories from being lost to readers under the strict Puritan influence of the time. Hornbooks also appeared in England during this time, teaching children basic information such as the alphabet and the Lord's Prayer. These were brought from England to the American colonies in the mid-seventeenth century. The first such book was a catechism for children, written in verse by the Puritan John Cotton. Known as *Spiritual Milk for Boston Babes*, it was published in 1646, appearing both in England and Boston. Another early book, *The New England Primer*, was in print by 1691 and used in schools for 100 years. The primer begins with "The young Infant's or Child's morning Prayer" and evening prayer.

It then shows the alphabet, vowels, consonants, double letters, and syllables before providing a religious rhyme of the alphabet, beginning "In Adam's fall We sinned all... ", and continues through

the alphabet. It also contained religious maxims, acronyms, spelling help and other educational items, all decorated by woodcuts. In 1634, the *Pentamerone* from Italy became the first major published collection of European folk tales. Charles Perrault began recording fairy tales in France, publishing his first collection in 1697. They were not well received among the French literary society, who saw them as only fit for old people and children. In 1658, John Amos Comenius in Bohemia published the informative illustrated *Orbis Pictus*, for children under six learning to read. It is considered to be the first picture book produced specifically for children. The first Danish children's book was *The Child's Mirror* by Niels Bredal in 1568, an adaptation of a courtesy book by the Dutch priest Erasmus.

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A Pretty and Splendid Maiden's Mirror, an adaptation of a German book for young women, became the first Swedish children's book upon its 1591 publication. Sweden published fables and a children's magazine by 1766. In Italy, Giovanni Francesco Straparola released *The Facetious Nights of Straparola* in the 1550s. Called the first European storybook to contain fairy-tales, it eventually had 75 separate stories and written for an adult audience. Giulio Cesare Croce also borrowed from some stories children enjoyed for his books. Russia's earliest children's books, primers, appeared in the late sixteenth century. An early example is *ABC-Book*, an alphabet book published by Ivan Fyodorov in 1571. The first picture book published in Russia, Karion Istomin's *The Illustrated Primer*, appeared in 1694. Peter the Great's interest in modernizing his country through Westernization helped Western children's literature dominate the field through the eighteenth century.

Catherine the Great wrote allegories for children, and during her reign, Nikolai Novikov started the first juvenile magazine in Russia. === Origins of the modern genre === The modern children's book emerged in mid-18th-century England. A growing polite middle-class and the influence of Lockean theories of childhood innocence combined to create the beginnings of childhood as a concept. In an article for the British Library, professor MO Grenby writes, "in the 1740s, a cluster of London publishers began to produce new books designed to instruct and delight young readers. Thomas Boreman was one. Another was Mary Cooper, whose two-volume *Tommy Thumb's Pretty Song Book* (1744) is the first known nursery rhyme collection. But the most celebrated of these pioneers is John Newbery, whose first book for the entertainment of children was *A Little Pretty Pocket-Book*. " Widely considered the first modern children's book, *A Little Pretty Pocket-Book* was the first children's publication aimed at giving enjoyment to children, containing a mixture of rhymes, picture

stories and games for pleasure.

Newbery believed that play was a better enticement to children's good behavior than physical discipline, and the child was to record his or her behaviour daily. The book was child-sized with a brightly colored cover that appealed to children—something new in the publishing industry. Known as gift books, these early books became the precursors to the toy books popular in the nineteenth century. Newbery was also adept at marketing this new genre. According to the journal *The Lion and the Unicorn*, "Newbery's genius was in developing the fairly new product category, children's books, through his frequent advertisements... and his clever ploy of introducing additional titles and products into the body of his children's books. " Professor Grenby writes, "Newbery has become known as the 'father of children's literature' chiefly because he was able to show that publishing children's books could be a commercial success. " The improvement in the quality of books for children and the diversity of topics he published helped make Newbery the leading producer of children's books in his time.

He published his own books as well as those by authors such as Samuel Johnson and Oliver Goldsmith; the latter may have written *The History of Little Goody Two-Shoes*, Newbery's most popular book. Another philosopher who influenced the development of children's literature was Jean-Jacques Rousseau, who argued that children should be allowed to develop naturally and joyously. His idea of appealing to a children's natural interests took hold among writers for children. Popular examples included Thomas Day's *The History of Sandford and Merton*, four volumes that embody Rousseau's theories. Furthermore, Maria and Richard Lovell Edgeworth's *Practical Education: The History of Harry and Lucy* (1780) urged children to teach themselves. Rousseau's ideas also had great influence in Germany, especially on German Philanthropism, a movement concerned with reforming both education and literature for children. Its founder, Johann Bernhard Basedow, authored *Elementarwerk* as a popular textbook for children that included many illustrations by Daniel Chodowiecki.

Another follower, Joachim Heinrich Campe, created an adaptation of *Robinson Crusoe* that went into over 100 printings. He became Germany's "outstanding and most modern" writer for children. According to Hans-Heino Ewers in *The International Companion Encyclopedia of Children's Literature*, "It can be argued that from this time, the history of European children's literature was largely written in Germany. " The Brothers Grimm preserved and published the traditional tales told in Germany. They were so popular in their home country that modern, realistic children's literature began to be looked down on there. This dislike of non-traditional stories continued there until the

beginning of the next century. In addition to their collection of stories, the Grimm brothers also contributed to children's literature through their academic pursuits.

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As professors, they had a scholarly interest in the stories, striving to preserve them and their variations accurately, recording their sources. A similar project was carried out by the Norwegian scholars Peter Christen Asbjørnsen and Jørgen Moe, who collected Norwegian fairy tales and published them as *Norwegian Folktales*, often referred to as Asbjørnsen and Moe. By compiling these stories, they preserved Norway's literary heritage and helped create the Norwegian written language. Danish author and poet Hans Christian Andersen traveled through Europe and gathered many well-known fairy tales and created new stories in the fairy tale genre. In Switzerland, Johann David Wyss published *The Swiss Family Robinson* in 1812, with the aim of teaching children about family values, good husbandry, the uses of the natural world and self-reliance. The book became popular across Europe after it was translated into French by Isabelle de Montolieu. E. T. A.

Hoffmann's tale "The Nutcracker and the Mouse King" was published in 1816 in a German collection of stories for children, *Kinder-Märchen*. It is the first modern short story to introduce bizarre, odd and grotesque elements in children's literature and thereby anticipates Lewis Carroll's tale, *Alice's Adventures in Wonderland*. There are not only parallels concerning the content (the weird adventures of a young girl in a fantasy land), but also the origin of the tales as both are dedicated and given to a daughter of the author's friends. === Golden age === The shift to a modern genre of children's literature occurred in the mid-19th century; didacticism of a previous age began to make way for more humorous, child-oriented books, more attuned to the child's imagination.

The availability of children's literature greatly increased as well, as paper and printing became widely available and affordable, the population grew and literacy rates improved. *Tom Brown's School Days* by Thomas Hughes appeared in 1857, and is considered to be the founding book in the school story tradition. However, it was Lewis Carroll's fantasy, *Alice's Adventures in Wonderland*, published in 1865 in England, that signaled the change in writing style for children to an imaginative and empathetic one. Regarded as the first "English masterpiece written for children" and as a founding book in the development of fantasy literature, its publication opened the "First Golden Age" of children's literature in Britain and Europe that continued until the early 1900s. The fairy-tale absurdity of *Wonderland* has solid historical ground as a satire of the serious problems of the Victorian era.

Lewis Carroll is ironic about the prim and all-out regulated life of the "golden" Victorian century. One other noteworthy publication was Mark Twain's book *Tom Sawyer* (1876), which was one of the first "boy books", intended for children but enjoyed by both children and adults alike. These were classified as such for the themes they contained, consisting of fighting and work. Another important book of that decade was *The Water-Babies, A Fairy Tale for a Land Baby*, by Rev. Charles Kingsley (1862), which became extremely popular and remains a classic of British children's literature. In 1883, Carlo Collodi wrote the first Italian fantasy novel, *The Adventures of Pinocchio*, which was translated many times. In that same year, Emilio Salgari, the man who would become "the adventure writer par excellence for the young in Italy" first published his legendary character Sandokan.

In Britain, *The Princess and the Goblin* and its sequel *The Princess and Curdie*, by George MacDonald, appeared in 1872 and 1883, and the adventure stories *Treasure Island* and *Kidnapped*, both by Robert Louis Stevenson, were extremely popular in the 1880s. Rudyard Kipling's *The Jungle Book* was first published in 1894, and J. M. Barrie told the story of Peter Pan in the novel *Peter and Wendy* in 1911. Johanna Spyri's two-part novel *Heidi* was published in Switzerland in 1880 and 1881. In the US, children's publishing entered a period of growth after the American Civil War in 1865. Boys' book writer Oliver Optic published over 100 books. In 1868, the "epoch-making" *Little Women*, the fictionalized autobiography of Louisa May Alcott, was published. This "coming of age" story established the genre of realistic family books in the United States. Mark Twain released *Tom Sawyer* in 1876. In 1880 another bestseller, *Uncle Remus: His Songs and His Sayings*, a collection of African American folk tales adapted and compiled by Joel Chandler Harris, appeared.

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In the late nineteenth and early twentieth centuries, a plethora of children's novels began featuring realistic, non-magical plotlines. Certain titles received international success such as Robert Louis Stevenson's *Treasure Island* (1883), L. M. Montgomery's *Anne of Green Gables* (1908), and Louisa May Alcott's *Little Women* (1869). == National traditions == === United Kingdom === Literature for children had developed as a separate category of literature especially in the Victorian era, with some works becoming internationally known, such as Lewis Carroll's *Alice's Adventures in Wonderland* (1865) and its sequel *Through the Looking-Glass* (1871). Another classic of the period is Anna Sewell's animal novel *Black Beauty* (1877). At the end of the Victorian era and leading into the Edwardian era, author and illustrator Beatrix Potter published *The Tale of Peter Rabbit* in 1902. Potter

went on to produce 23 children's books and become very wealthy. A pioneer of character merchandising, in 1903 she patented a Peter Rabbit doll, making Peter the first licensed character. Michael O. Tunnell and James S.

Jacobs, professors of children's literature at Brigham Young University, write, "Potter was the first to use pictures as well as words to tell the story, incorporating coloured illustration with text, page for page. " Rudyard Kipling published *The Jungle Book* in 1894. A major theme in the book is abandonment followed by fostering, as in the life of Mowgli, echoing Kipling's own childhood. In the latter years of the 19th century, precursors of the modern picture book were illustrated books of poems and short stories produced by English illustrators Randolph Caldecott, Walter Crane, and Kate Greenaway. These had a larger proportion of pictures to words than earlier books, and many of their pictures were in colour. Some British artists made their living illustrating novels and children's books, among them Arthur Rackham, Cicely Mary Barker, W. Heath Robinson, Henry J. Ford, John Leech, and George Cruikshank.

In the 1890s, some of the best known fairy tales from England were compiled in Joseph Jacobs' *English Fairy Tales*, including *Jack and the Beanstalk*, *Goldilocks and the Three Bears*, *The Three Little Pigs*, *Jack the Giant Killer* and *Tom Thumb*. The Kailyard School of Scottish writers, notably J. M. Barrie, creator of *Peter Pan* (1904), presented an idealised version of society and brought fantasy and folklore back into fashion. In 1908, Kenneth Grahame wrote the children's classic *The Wind in the Willows* and the Scouts founder Robert Baden-Powell's first book, *Scouting for Boys*, was published. Inspiration for Frances Hodgson Burnett's novel *The Secret Garden* (1910) was the Great Maytham Hall Garden in Kent. While fighting in the trenches for the British Army in World War I, Hugh Lofting created the character of Doctor Dolittle, who appears in a series of twelve books. The Golden Age of Children's Literature ended with World War I.

The period before World War II was much slower in children's publishing. The main exceptions in England were the publications of *Winnie-the-Pooh* by A. A. Milne in 1926, *Tales of Toytown* by S. G. Hulme Beaman in 1928, the first *Mary Poppins* book by P. L. Travers in 1934, *The Hobbit* by J. R. R. Tolkien in 1937, and the Arthurian *The Sword in the Stone* by T. H. White in 1938. Children's mass paperback books were first released in England in 1940 under the Puffin Books imprint, and their lower prices helped make book buying possible for children during World War II. Enid Blyton's books have been among the world's bestsellers since the 1930s, selling more than 600 million copies. Blyton's books are still enormously popular and have been translated into almost 90 languages. She wrote on a wide range of topics including education, natural history, fantasy, mystery, and biblical

narratives and is best remembered today for her Noddy, The Famous Five, The Secret Seven, and The Adventure Series.

The first of these children's stories, *Five on a Treasure Island*, was published in 1942. In the 1950s, the book market in Europe began to recover from the effects of the two world wars. An informal literary discussion group associated with the English faculty at the University of Oxford, were the "Inklings", with the major fantasy novelists C. S. Lewis and J. R. R. Tolkien as its main members. C. S. Lewis published the first installment of *The Chronicles of Narnia* series in 1950, while Tolkien is best known, in addition to *The Hobbit*, as the author of *The Lord of the Rings* (1954). Another writer of fantasy stories is Alan Garner author of *Elidor* (1965), and *The Owl Service* (1967). The latter is an adaptation of the myth of *Blodeuwedd* from the *Mabinogion*, set in modern Wales – it won Garner the annual Carnegie Medal from the Library Association, recognising the year's best children's book by a British author. Mary Norton wrote *The Borrowers* (1952), featuring tiny people who borrow from humans. Dodie Smith's *The Hundred and One Dalmatians* was published in 1956.

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Philippa Pearce's *Tom's Midnight Garden* (1958) has Tom opening the garden door at night and entering into a different age. Roald Dahl wrote children's fantasy novels which were often inspired from experiences from his childhood, with often unexpected endings, and unsentimental, dark humour. Dahl was inspired to write *Charlie and the Chocolate Factory* (1964), featuring the eccentric chocolatier Willy Wonka, having grown up near two chocolate makers in England who often tried to steal trade secrets by sending spies into the other's factory. His other works include *James and the Giant Peach* (1961), *Fantastic Mr. Fox* (1970), *The BFG* (1982), *The Witches* (1983), and *Matilda* (1988). Starting in 1958, Michael Bond published more than twenty humorous stories about *Paddington Bear*. Boarding schools in literature are centred on older pre-adolescent and adolescent school life, and are most commonly set in English boarding schools.

Popular school stories from this period include Ronald Searle's comic *St Trinian's* (1949–1953) and his illustrations for Geoffrey Willans's *Molesworth* series, Jill Murphy's *The Worst Witch*, and the *Jennings* series by Anthony Buckeridge. Ruth Manning-Sanders's first collection, *A Book of Giants*, retells a number of giant stories from around the world. Susan Cooper's *The Dark Is Rising* is a five-volume fantasy saga set in England and Wales. Raymond Briggs' children's picture book *The Snowman* (1978) has been adapted as an animation, shown every Christmas on British television. The

Reverend. W. Awdry and son Christopher's *The Railway Series* features Thomas the Tank Engine. Margery Sharp's series *The Rescuers* is based on a heroic mouse organisation. The third Children's Laureate Michael Morpurgo published *War Horse* in 1982. Dick King-Smith's novels include *The Sheep-Pig* (1984). Diana Wynne Jones wrote the young adult fantasy novel *Howl's Moving Castle* in 1986. Anne Fine's *Madame Doubtfire* (1987) is based around a family with divorced parents.

Anthony Horowitz's *Alex Rider* series begins with *Stormbreaker* (2000). Philip Pullman's *His Dark Materials* is an epic trilogy of fantasy novels consisting of *Northern Lights* (1995, published as *The Golden Compass* in North America), *The Subtle Knife* (1997), and *The Amber Spyglass* (2000). It follows the coming of age of two children, Lyra Belacqua and Will Parry, as they wander through a series of parallel universes. The three novels have won a number of awards, most notably the 2001 Whitbread Book of the Year prize, won by *The Amber Spyglass*. *Northern Lights* won the Carnegie Medal for children's fiction in 1995. J. K. Rowling's *Harry Potter* fantasy sequence of seven novels chronicles the adventures of the adolescent wizard Harry Potter. The series began with *Harry Potter and the Philosopher's Stone* in 1997 and ended with the seventh and final book *Harry Potter and the Deathly Hallows* in 2007; becoming the best selling book-series in history.

The series has been translated into 67 languages, so placing Rowling among the most translated authors in history. Neil Gaiman wrote the dark fantasy novella *Coraline* (2002). His 2008 fantasy, *The Graveyard Book*, traces the story of a boy who is raised by the supernatural occupants of a graveyard. In 2001, Terry Pratchett received the Carnegie Medal (his first major award) for *The Amazing Maurice and His Educated Rodents*. Cressida Cowell's *How to Train Your Dragon* series was published between 2003 and 2015. Adventure fiction While Daniel Defoe wrote *Robinson Crusoe* in 1719 (spawning so many imitations it defined a genre, *Robinsonade*), adventure stories written specifically for children began in the nineteenth century. Early examples from British authors include Frederick Marryat's *The Children of the New Forest* (1847) and Harriet Martineau's *The Peasant and the Prince* (1856).

The Victorian era saw the development of the genre, with W. H. G. Kingston, R. M. Ballantyne and G. A. Henty specializing in the production of adventure fiction for boys. This inspired writers who normally catered to adult audiences to write for children, a notable example being Robert Louis Stevenson's classic pirate story *Treasure Island* (1883). In the years after the First World War, writers such as Arthur Ransome developed the adventure genre by setting the adventure in Britain rather than distant countries. In the 1930s he began publishing his *Swallows and Amazons* series of children's books about the school-holiday adventures of children, mostly in the English Lake District and the

Norfolk Broads. Many of them involve sailing; fishing and camping are other common subjects. Biggles was a popular series of adventure books for young boys, about James Bigglesworth, a fictional pilot and adventurer, by W. E. Johns. Between 1941 and 1961 there were 60 issues with stories about Biggles, and in the 1960s occasional contributors included the BBC astronomer Patrick Moore. Between 1940 and 1947, W. E.

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Johns contributed sixty stories featuring the female pilot Worrals. William Golding's 1954 dystopian adventure novel *Lord of the Flies* focuses on a group of British boys stranded on an uninhabited island and their disastrous attempt to govern themselves. Evoking epic themes, Richard Adams's 1972 survival and adventure novel *Watership Down* follows a small group of rabbits who escape the destruction of their warren and seek to establish a new home. Geoffrey Trease and Rosemary Sutcliff brought a new sophistication to the historical adventure novel. Philip Pullman in the Sally Lockhart novels and Julia Golding in the *Cat Royal* series have continued the tradition of the historical adventure. ===== Magazines and comics ===== An important aspect of British children's literature has been comic books and magazines. Amongst the most popular and longest running comics have been *The Beano* and *The Dandy*, both first published in the 1930s.

British comics in the 20th century evolved from illustrated penny dreadfuls of the Victorian era (featuring *Sweeney Todd*, *Dick Turpin* and *Varney the Vampire*). First published in the 1830s, according to *The Guardian*, penny dreadfuls were "Britain's first taste of mass-produced popular culture for the young." *Robin Hood* featured in a series of penny dreadfuls in 1838 which sparked the beginning of the mass circulation of Robin stories. *Dennis the Menace* debuted in *The Beano* in 1951, while the popular stop-motion characters, *Wallace and Gromit*, guest-starred in the comic every four weeks from 2013. Important early magazines or story papers for older children were the *Boy's Own Paper*, published from 1879 to 1967 and *The Girl's Own Paper* published from 1880 until 1956. In the 1890s, half-penny publications succeeded the penny dreadfuls in popularity among British children. These included *The Half-penny Marvel* and *Union Jack*.

From 1896, the cover of the half-penny comic *Illustrated Chips* featured the long-running comic strip of the tramps *Weary Willie* and *Tired Tim*, with its readers including a young Charlie Chaplin. Other story papers for older boys were *The Hotspur* (1933 to 1959) and *The Rover*, which started in 1922 and was absorbed into *Adventure* in 1961 and *The Wizard* in 1963, and eventually folded in 1973.

Many prominent authors contributed to the Boy's Own Paper: cricketer W. G. Grace wrote for several issues, along with authors Sir Arthur Conan Doyle and R. M. Ballantyne, as well as Robert Baden-Powell, founder of the Scout Movement. Contributors to The Girl's Own Paper included Noel Streatfeild, Rosa Nouchette Carey, Sarah Doudney (1841–1926), Angela Brazil, Richmal Crompton, Fanny Fern, and Baroness Orczy. The Eagle was a popular British comic for boys, launched in 1950 by Marcus Morris, an Anglican vicar from Lancashire.

Revolutionary in its presentation and content, it was enormously successful; the first issue sold about 900,000 copies. Featured in colour on the front cover was its most recognisable story, "Dan Dare, Pilot of the Future", created with meticulous attention to detail. It was first published from 1950 to 1969, and relaunched from 1982 to 1994. Its sister comic was Girl, whose early issues from 1951 featured the strip "Kitty Hawke and her All-Girl Air Crew". Roy of the Rovers, an immensely popular comic strip featuring Roy Race, a striker for the fictional football team Melchester Rovers, first appeared in the Tiger in 1954. First published by Martin Handford in 1987, more than 73 million Where's Wally? picture puzzle books had been sold around the world by 2007. === United States === Children's literature has been a part of American culture since Europeans first settled in America. The earliest books were used as tools to instill self-control in children and preach a life of morality in Puritan society.

Eighteenth-century American youth began to shift away from the social upbringing of its European counterpart, bringing about a change in children's literature. It was in this time that A Little Book for Little Children was written by T. W. in 1712. It includes what is thought to be the earliest nursery rhyme and one of the earliest examples of a textbook approaching education from the child's point of view, rather than the adult's. Children's magazines in the United States began with the Young Misses' Magazine (1806) of Brooklyn, New York. One of the most famous books of American children's literature is L. Frank Baum's fantasy novel The Wonderful Wizard of Oz, published in 1900. "By combining the English fondness for word play with the American appetite for outdoor adventure", Connie Epstein in International Companion Encyclopedia Of Children's Literature says Baum "developed an original style and form that stands alone".

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Baum wrote fourteen more Oz novels, and other writers continued the Oz series into the twenty-first century. Demand continued to grow in North America between World War I and World War II, helped

by the growth of libraries in both Canada and the United States. Children's reading rooms in libraries, staffed by specially trained librarians, helped create demand for classic juvenile books. Reviews of children's releases began appearing regularly in *Publishers Weekly* and in *The Bookman* magazine began to publish regular reviews of children's releases. The first Children's Book Week was launched in 1919. In that same year, Louise Seaman Bechtel became the first person to head a juvenile book publishing department in the country. She was followed by May Massee in 1922, and Alice Dalgliesh in 1934. During this period, Black authors began writing and publishing books for African American children. Writers like Helen Adele Whiting (1885–1959) and Jane Dabney Shackelford (1895–1979) produced books designed to instill pride in Black history and culture.

The American Library Association began awarding the Newbery Medal, the first children's book award, in 1922. The Caldecott Medal for illustration followed in 1938. The first book by Laura Ingalls Wilder about her life on the American frontier, *Little House in the Big Woods* appeared in 1932. In 1937 Dr. Seuss published his first book, entitled, *And to Think That I Saw It on Mulberry Street*. The young adult book market developed during this period, thanks to sports books by popular writer John R. Tunis', the novel *Seventeenth Summer* by Maureen Daly, and the Sue Barton nurse book series by Helen Dore Boylston. The already vigorous growth in children's books became a boom in the 1950s, and children's publishing became big business. In 1952, American journalist E. B. White published *Charlotte's Web*, which was described as "one of the very few books for young children that face, squarely, the subject of death". Maurice Sendak illustrated more than two dozen books during the decade, which established him as an innovator in book illustration.

The Sputnik crisis that began in 1957, provided increased interest and government money for schools and libraries to buy science and math books and the non-fiction book market "seemed to materialize overnight". The 1960s saw an age of new realism in children's books emerge. Given the atmosphere of social revolution in 1960s America, authors and illustrators began to break previously established taboos in children's literature. Controversial subjects dealing with alcoholism, death, divorce, and child abuse were now being published in stories for children. Maurice Sendak's *Where the Wild Things Are* in 1963 and Louise Fitzhugh's *Harriet the Spy* in 1964 are often considered the first stories published in this new age of realism. Esther Forbes in *Johnny Tremain* (1943) and Mildred D. Taylor in *Roll of Thunder, Hear My Cry* (1976) continued the tradition of the historical adventure in an American setting.

The modern children's adventure novel sometimes deals with controversial issues like terrorism, as in Robert Cormier's *After the First Death* in 1979, and warfare in the Third World, as in Peter

Dickinson's *AK* in 1990. In books for a younger age group, Bill Martin and John Archambault's *Chicka Chicka Boom Boom* (1989) presented a new spin on the alphabet book. Laura Numeroff published *If You Give a Mouse a Cookie* in 1985 and went on to create a series of similarly named books that is still popular for children and adults to read together. Lloyd Alexander's *The Chronicles of Prydain* (1964–1968) was set in a fictionalized version of medieval Britain. == Continental Europe == Johann David Wyss wrote the adventure novel *The Swiss Family Robinson* (1812). The period from 1890 until World War I is considered the Golden Age of Children's Literature in Scandinavia. Erik Werenskiöld, Theodor Kittelsen, and Dikken Zwilgmeyer were especially popular, writing folk and fairy tales as well as realistic fiction. The 1859 translation into English by George Webbe Dasent helped increase the stories' influence.

One of the most influential and internationally most successful Scandinavian children's books from this period is Selma Lagerlöfs *The Wonderful Adventures of Nils*. Astrid Lindgren (*Pippi Longstocking*) and Jostein Gaarder (*Sophie's World*) are two of the best-known Scandinavian writers internationally. In Finland, some of the most significant children's book writers include Tove Jansson (*Moomins*), Oiva Paloheimo (*Tirlittan*) and Elina Karjalainen (*Uppo-Nalle*). The interwar period saw a slow-down in output similar to Britain's, although "one of the first mysteries written specifically for children", *Emil and the Detectives* by Erich Kästner, was published in Germany in 1930. German writers Michael Ende (*The Neverending Story*) and Cornelia Funke (*Inkheart*) achieved international success with their fantasy books. The period during and following World War II became the Classic Age of the picture book in Switzerland, with works by Alois Carigiet, Felix Hoffmann, and Hans Fischer.

Chapter 9

Nineteen sixty-three was the first year of the Bologna Children's Book Fair in Italy, which was described as "the most important international event dedicated to the children's publishing". For four days it brings together writers, illustrators, publishers, and book buyers from around the world. == Russia and the Soviet Union == Russian folktales were collected by Aleksandr Afanasyev in his three-volume *Narodnye russkie skazki*, and a selection of these were published in *BCD AC8CP CD5D Children's Fairy Tales*) in 1871. By the 1860s, literary realism and non-fiction dominated children's literature. More schools were started, using books by writers like Konstantin Ushinsky and Leo Tolstoy, whose *Russian Reader* included an assortment of stories, fairy tales, and fables. Books

written specifically for girls developed in the 1870s and 1880s.

Publisher and journalist Evgenia Tur wrote about the daughters of well-to-do landowners, while Alexandra Nikitichna Annenskaya's stories told of middle-class girls working to support themselves. Vera Zhelikhovsky, Elizaveta Kondrashova, and Nadezhda Lukhmanova also wrote for girls during this period. Children's non-fiction gained great importance in Russia at the beginning of the century. A ten-volume children's encyclopedia was published between 1913 and 1914. Vasily Avenarius wrote fictionalized biographies of important people like Nikolai Gogol and Alexander Pushkin around the same time, and scientists wrote for books and magazines for children. Children's magazines flourished, and by the end of the century there were 61. Lidia Charskaya and Klavdiya Lukashevich continued the popularity of girls' fiction. Realism took a gloomy turn by frequently showing the maltreatment of children from lower classes. The most popular boys' material was Sherlock Holmes, and similar stories from detective magazines. The state took control of children's literature during the October Revolution.

Maksim Gorky edited the first children's *Northern Lights* under Soviet rule. People often label the 1920s as the Golden Age of Children's Literature in Russia. Samuil Marshak led that literary decade as the "founder of (Soviet) children's literature". As head of the children's section of the State Publishing House and editor of several children's magazines, Marshak exercised enormous influence by recruiting Boris Pasternak and Osip Mandelstam to write for children. In 1932, professional writers in the Soviet Union formed the USSR Union of Writers, which served as the writer's organization of the Communist Party. With a children's branch, the official oversight of the professional organization brought children's writers under the control of the state and the police. Communist principles like collectivism and solidarity became important themes in children's literature. Authors wrote biographies about revolutionaries like Lenin and Pavlik Morozov.

Alexander Belyayev, who wrote in the 1920s and 1930s, became Russia's first science fiction writer. According to Ben Hellman in the *International Companion Encyclopedia of Children's Literature*, "war was to occupy a prominent place in juvenile reading, partly compensating for the lack of adventure stories", during the Soviet Period. More political changes in Russia after World War II brought further change in children's literature. Today, the field is in a state of flux because some older authors are being rediscovered and others are being abandoned. === China === The 1911 Revolution and World War II brought political and social change that revolutionized children's literature in China. Western science, technology, and literature became fashionable. China's first modern publishing firm, Commercial Press, established several children's magazines, which included *Youth Magazine*, and

Educational Pictures for Children.

The first Chinese children's writer was Sun Yuxiu, an editor of Commercial Press, whose story *The Kingdom Without a Cat* was written in the language of the time instead of the classical style used previously. Yuxiu encouraged novelist Shen Dehong to write for children as well. Dehong went on to rewrite 28 stories based on classical Chinese literature specifically for children. In 1932, Zhang Tianyi published *Big Lin and Little Lin*, the first full-length Chinese novel for children. The Chinese Communist Revolution changed children's literature again. Many children's writers were denounced, but Tianyi and Ye Shengtao continued to write for children and created works that were aligned with Maoist ideology. The 1976 death of Mao Zedong provoked more changes that swept China. The work of many writers from the early part of the century became available again. In 1990 came *General Anthology of Modern Children's Literature of China*, a fifteen-volume anthology of children's literature since the 1920s.

Chapter 10

=== Brazil === In Brazil, Monteiro Lobato wrote a series of 23 books for children known as *Sítio do Picapau Amarelo* (The Yellow Woodpecker Ranch), between 1920 and 1940. The series is considered representative of Brazilian children's literature and the Brazilian equivalent to children's classics such as C. S. Lewis, *The Chronicles of Narnia* and L. Frank Baum's *The Wonderful Wizard of Oz* series. The concept was introduced in Monteiro Lobato's 1920 short story "A Menina do Narizinho Arrebitado", and was later republished as the first chapter of "Reinações de Narizinho", which is the first novel of the series. The main setting is the "Sítio do Picapau Amarelo", where a boy (Pedrinho), a girl (Narizinho) and their living and thinking anthropomorphic toys enjoy exploring adventures in fantasy, discovery and learning.

On several occasions, they leave the ranch to explore other worlds such as Neverland, the mythological Ancient Greece, an underwater world known as "Reino das Águas Claras" (Clear Waters Kingdom), and even the outer space. The "Sítio" is often symbolized by the character of Emília, Lobato's most famous creation. === India === Christian missionaries first established the Calcutta School-Book Society in the 19th century, creating a separate genre for children's literature in the country. Magazines and books for children in native languages soon appeared. In the latter half of the century, Raja Shivprasad wrote several well-known books in Hindustani. A number of respected Bengali writers began producing Bengali literature for children, including Ishwar Chandra

Vidyasagar, who translated some stories and wrote others himself. Nobel Prize-winner Rabindranath Tagore wrote plays, stories, and poems for children, including one work illustrated by painter Nandalal Bose.

They worked from the end of the nineteenth century into the beginning of the twentieth. Tagore's work was later translated into English, with Bose's pictures. Behari Lal Puri was the earliest writer for children in Punjabi. His stories were didactic in nature. The first full-length children's book was Khar Khar Mahadev by Narain Dixit, which was serialized in one of the popular children's magazines in 1957. Other writers include Premchand, and poet Sohan Lal Dwivedi. In 1919, Sukumar Ray wrote and illustrated nonsense rhymes in the Bengali language, and children's writer and artist Abanindranath Tagore finished Barngtarbratn. Bengali children's literature flourished in the later part of the twentieth century. Educator Gijubhai Badheka published over 200 books in the Children's literature in Gujarati language, and many are still popular. Other popular Gujarati children's authors were Ramanlal Soni and Jivram Joshi. In 1957, political cartoonist K. Shankar Pillai founded the Children's Book Trust publishing company.

The firm became known for high quality children's books, and many of them were released in several languages. One of the most distinguished writers is Pandit Krushna Chandra Kar in Oriya literature, who wrote many good books for children, including Pari Raija, Kuhuka Raija, Panchatantra, and Adi Jugara Galpa Mala. He wrote biographies of many historical personalities, such as Kapila Deva. In 1978, the firm organized a writers' competition to encourage quality children's writing. The following year, the Children's Book Trust began a writing workshop and organized the First International Children's Book Fair in New Delhi. Children's magazines, available in many languages, were widespread throughout India during this century. Ruskin Bond is also a famous Anglo-Indian writer for children. === Argentina === The origins of the Argentine children's literature tradition can be traced back to the publication of Leyendas Argentinas (Argentine Legends) in 1906 by Ada María Elflein, the Argentine daughter of German immigrants. Public schooling in Argentina was established in 1884 as free, compulsory and secular.

With the Bible absent from schools, children's literature became an essential tool through which moral values could be taught. School reading books supported the instruction of civic morality, helping to fill the gap left by the displacing of the Catholic Church from its traditional position of imparting moral values. The commercial implications of this persisted into the 2000s, when Argentine publishing houses marketed Roald Dahl to teachers by highlighting the values which are transmitted by each of his books. In 1918, Uruguayan author Horacio Quiroga published Cuentos de la Selva

(Tales of the Jungle) in Buenos Aires. A collection of short stories for children, about survival in the jungle of the Argentine Province of Misiones, bringing different types of animals into conflict or allegiance with each other and, occasionally, with humans.

Chapter 11

It was acclaimed due to the previous reputation Quiroga had obtained writing short stories for adults, particularly in *Cuentos de amor de locura y de muerte* (Tales of Love, Madness and Death). However, due to the lack of "moral content", the book was not read in schools. On the other hand, Constancio C.

